

Boat neck linen shell top

EU38 sewing guide . 3 pieces . 1.6 m fabric at 140 cm

text-first guide, no illustrations in this edition. Every step is the engine's own instruction.

Cut list

Top Front - cut 1 on fold

Top Back - cut 2

Strips / notions (chalked on fabric, not printed)

Bias binding (neckline + armholes) - cut 1 strip(s) 1218 x 25 mm ON THE BIAS (45° to the grain), join end to end (total 1218 mm)

Steps

1. Print and check the 3 cm calibration square before cutting.
2. This block uses standard assumptions for shoulder slope and underbust - sew a quick muslin first and adjust before cutting your real fabric.
3. Cut every piece as labelled ('on fold' on the fabric fold, 'cut 2' twice). Check the neck opening against your head circumference - a top has no zipper, it must slip over your head.
4. Staystitch the neckline just inside the seam line so it doesn't stretch while you work.
5. Sew the shoulder seams and press them open.
6. Prepare the neckline bias strip: join the ends as needed and press it in half lengthwise along the marked fold line.
7. Bind the neckline with the bias strip, right sides together and raw edges even, easing the strip gently around the curves. Trim to 6 mm, turn the folded edge to the inside and topstitch or slipstitch it down.
8. Sew the side seams.
9. Finish each armhole with its bias strip: press it in half, bind the armhole right sides together, ease around the curve, then turn and topstitch it to the inside.
10. Hem with a 2 cm double fold.